

Top Tools for Enterprise Architecture Development

Enterprise architecture is indispensable for any organisation that relies extensively on IT systems. The process of developing this architecture can be demanding and complex.

Fortunately, there are many tools available to ease the task of architects. Read on to familiarise yourself with some of the best ones, as well as a few best practices to follow when developing enterprise architecture.



Enterprise architecture (EA) is a strategic approach to designing, planning, implementing, and governing the IT systems and processes of an organisation. EA aligns the business goals, vision, and values with the IT capabilities, resources, and standards. It helps to create a holistic view of the current and future state of the organisation's IT landscape, and to identify the risks and opportunities for improvement.

In modern IT architecture, several reasons can lead to architecture failures. These include lack of executive support, insufficient communication and collaboration among EA stakeholders, as well as difficulty in defining and scoping the EA initiative and establishing the EA vision and strategy. Also, one must consider the complexity and diversity of IT systems and processes, and their lack of standardisation and interoperability. There is also

resistance to change and adoption of the EA standards and principles, and lack of EA skills and competencies during EA development.

Components of enterprise architecture

Defining the principles and designing the guidelines of an enterprise architecture involves various business, IT and technical stakeholders in order to

achieve the right strategy and roadmap for the enterprise.

There are five integral components of EA.

- **Organisational architecture**, which defines the roadmap and strategy of an IT office.
- **Business architecture**, which defines the priorities and expectations for a roadmap from business sponsors.

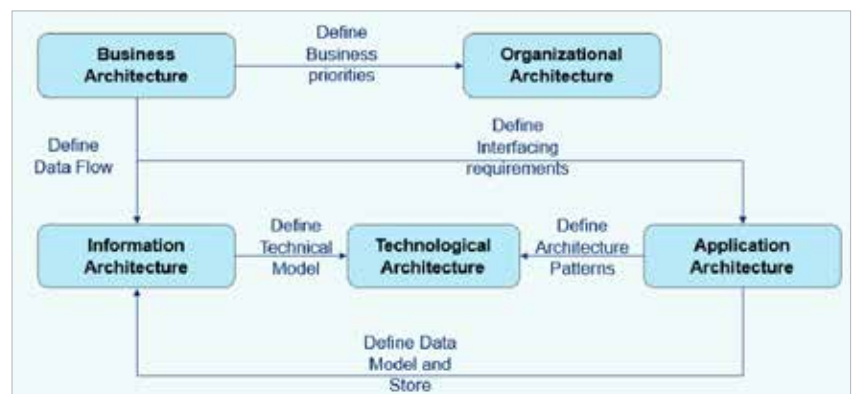


Figure 1: Components of enterprise architecture